



HISTORY AND CULTURAL HERITAGE OF ISTANBUL

week 1

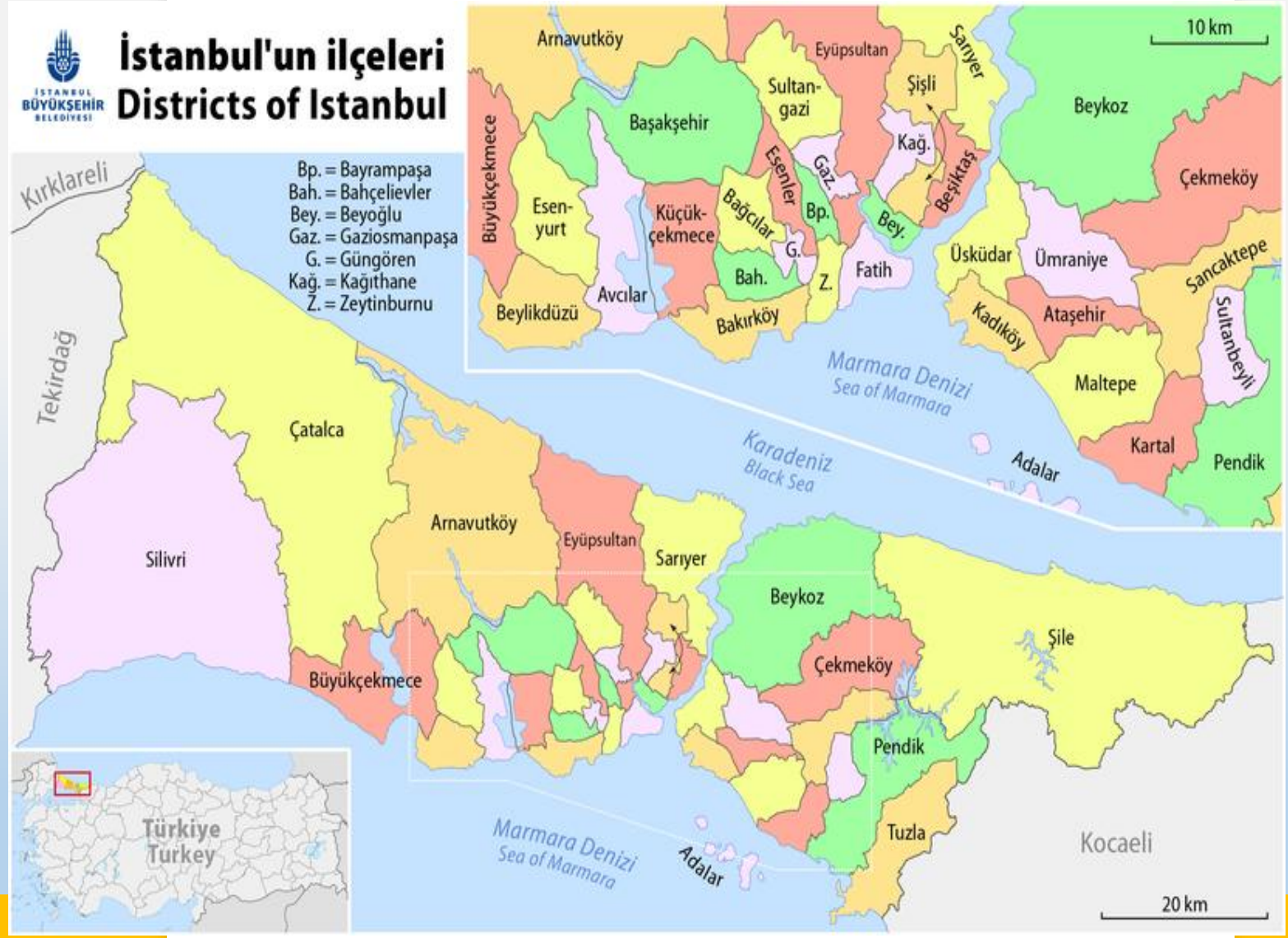


All other cities are mortal, but I think Istanbul will live as long as people exist.

Petrus Gyllius

today's Istanbul

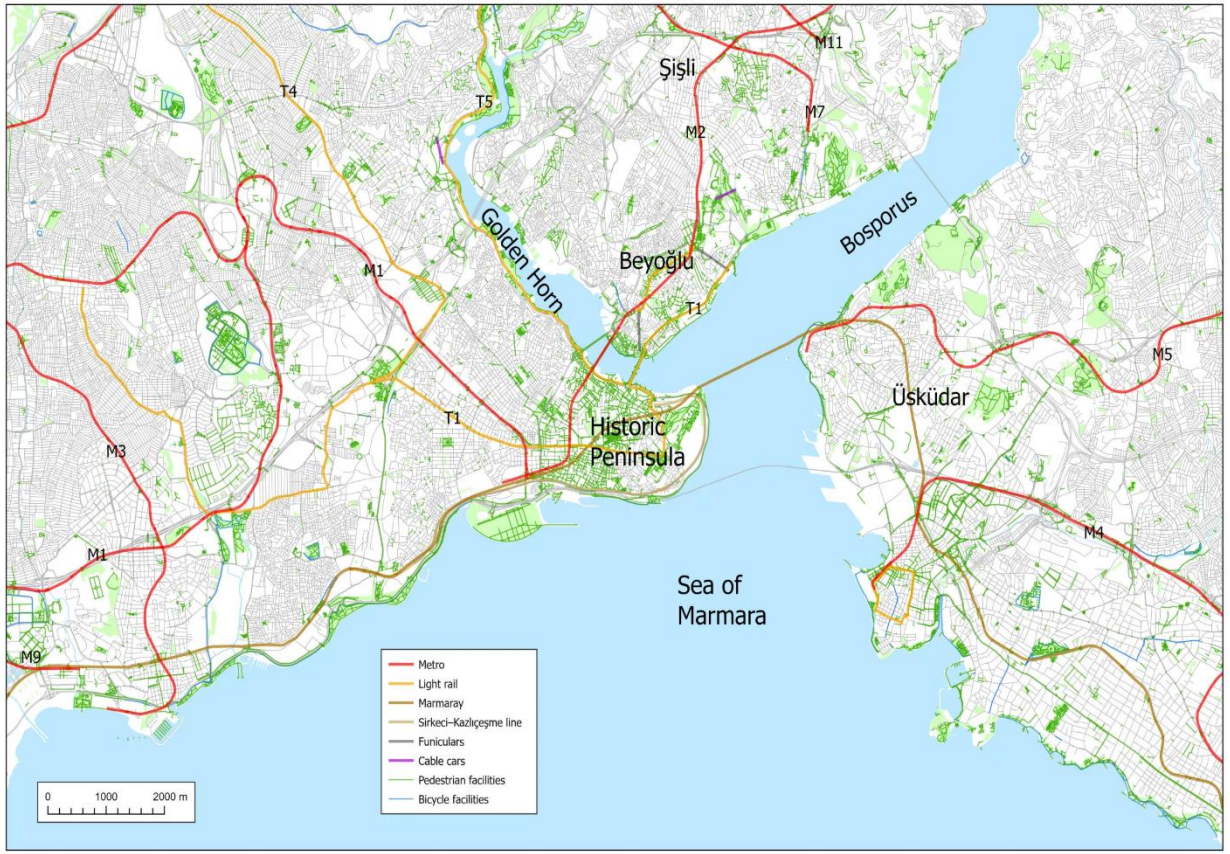
- There are a total of 39 districts in Istanbul. While 25 districts of Istanbul are located on the European side, 14 districts are located on the Anatolian side.
- More than 15 million people live here.

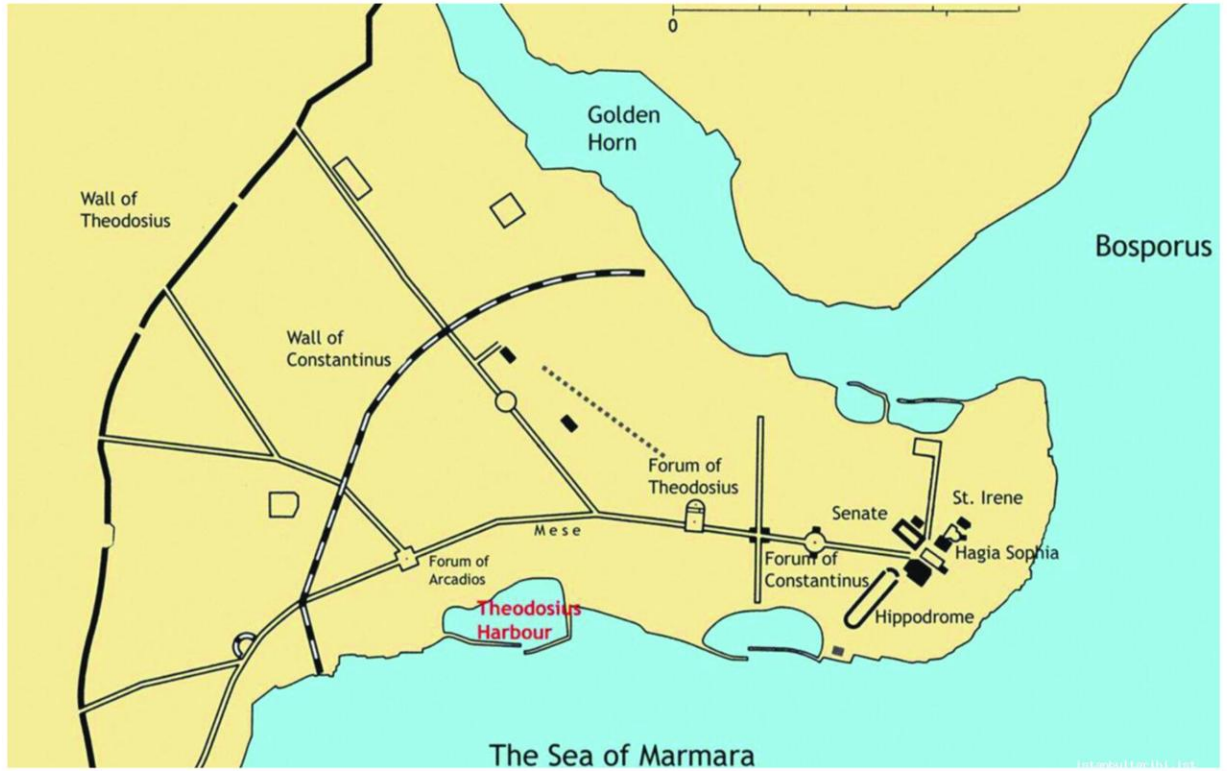


What was the city like in the past?

Historical Peninsula

- The part of Istanbul surrounded by the Golden Horn in the north, the Bosphorus in the east and the Marmara Sea in the south is today known as the "Historical Peninsula".
- known as “Suriçi” (literally, inner city walls).





- Istanbul was founded and developed as a city on this historical peninsula. The administrative center of Byzantium and later the Ottoman Empire was also here.

city walls:

-land walls -sea walls

Course Aim

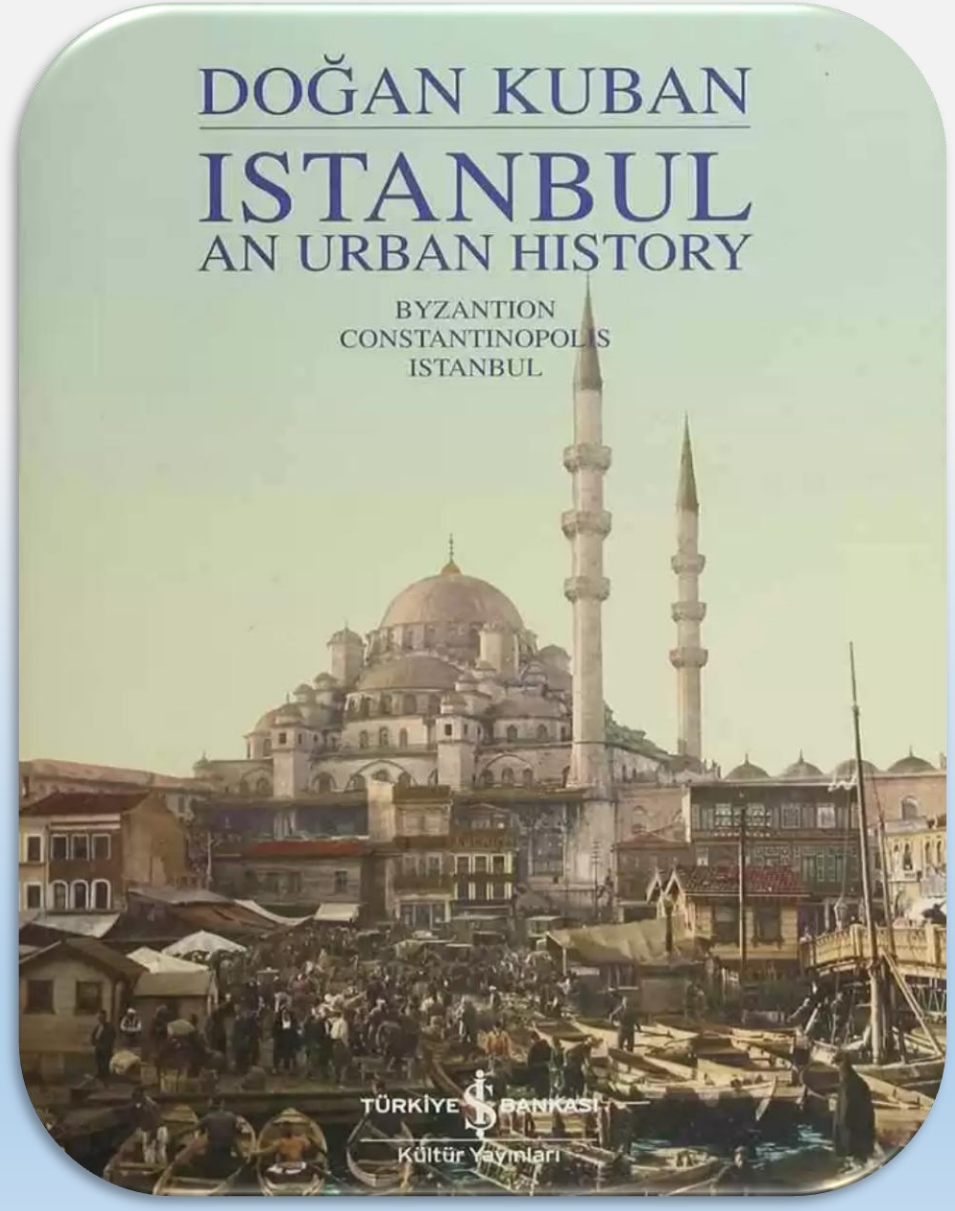
To examine the development of the Historical Peninsula from prehistoric times to the present within a chronological framework; to explore Istanbul's historical, cultural, and architectural heritage shaped by different civilizations; and to enable students to develop the ability to evaluate Istanbul's multi-layered urban identity, cultural heritage elements, and conservation approaches in their historical context.

Course Content

This course addresses the historical development of Istanbul from prehistoric times to the present through a chronological approach. Within this framework, Byzantion, Konstantinopolis, Ottoman Istanbul, and Republican-era Istanbul are examined with a special focus on the Historical Peninsula. The course discusses the city's military, civic, and religious architecture, monumental buildings, urban development, and cultural heritage. Furthermore, it explores Istanbul's multi-layered urban identity shaped by different civilizations, its architectural heritage, conservation approaches, and current issues related to cultural heritage.

MAIN READINGS

- Books
- Articles
- Lecture Notes (PDF or slides uploaded to Haliç-x)



EXAMS

the exams will be held **face to face.**

CONTACT

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PERIODS OF DOMINATION IN ISTANBUL



Istanbul is a city that has been the capital of three empires: Roman, Byzantine (esastern Roman) and Ottoman.

c. 695–667/660 BC	Megarans
667/660–c. 196 BC	Sieges and short-term rule of the Dorians, Ionians, Persians (Darius I, 5th century BC), and Spartans
196 BC	Roman rule (as a dependent city)
196 AD	Destruction of Byzantion by Septimius Severus
330–395	Roman Empire
395–1204 and 1261–1453	Eastern Roman Empire (Byzantine Empire)
1204–1261	Latin Empire
1453–1923	Ottoman Empire
1923	Republic of Türkiye

INTRODUCTION: BRIEF HISTORY OF THE CITY

- **Istanbul did not reach the status of an urban settlement until it came under Roman rule.**
- **Previous settlements were settlements of the colonial type.**

- **The city was included in the borders of the empire by the Roman Emperor Vespasian.**
- **The city was rebuilt during the reign of Emperor Septimus Sevesus.**
- **It remained a small city settlement for a long time during the Roman period. After the Roman Empire was divided into two (Eastern and Western Roman) in 324 AD, it became the capital of the Eastern Roman Empire.**
- **Roman Emperor Constantine I (Constantine the Great) made Istanbul the capital of his new empire. He started the construction of the city in 324. The city grew approximately 4 times. Structures such as palaces, temples, hippodromes and churches were built and the official opening was held on May 11, 330.**

So, **when was the first settlement on the Historical Peninsula?**

After the Yenikapı excavations, it was understood that the known settlement history of the Historical Peninsula dates back to around 6500 BC.

- **Although there is no definitive information about the oldest settlement date of the city, after the excavations in Yenikapı, it was revealed that the first settlement dates back to 6500 BC.***

- **Prehistoric Ages:**
  - Paleolithic Age
  - Mesolithic Age
  - Neolithic Age
  - Chalcolithic Age

- **Historical Ages**:
  - Ancient Age
  - Middle Age
  - Modern Age
  - Modern Age

YENIKAPI STRATIFICATION		
LAYER	DATING	PERIOD
0	1923 and later	Republic of Turkey
1	1453 - 1923	Ottoman Period
2	13th century AD - 1453	Late Byzantine Period
3	9th century AD - 12th century AD	Middle Byzantine Period
4	303 AD - 8th century AD	Early Byzantine Period
5	30 BC - 303 AD	Roman Period
6	334 BC - 30 BC	Hellenistic Era
7	800 BC- 334 BC	Archaic and Classical Periods
8	1200 BC - 800 BC	Iron Age
9	6500 BC - 5200 BC	Neolithic Period

**There are older settlements outside the old city but within the boundaries of modern Istanbul.*

- **The Yenikapı recovery excavations were carried out at the point where the Marmaray and Metro stations meet. Financed by two institutions, they started in 2004 and covered an area of 58,000 square meters. Surrounded by Namık Kemal Avenue from the North and Mustafa Kemal Avenue from the East and railway from the South, this area was designated as the common station for both projects.**

- **Archeological recovery excavations were undertaken in five zones, four in the Marmaray station area and one in the Yenikapı Metro station area.**



Aerial view of Yenikapı excavation area

We will come back to the Yenikapı excavations and their findings later…

The City

- Almost all disciplines that may be interested in the city have a specific definition of the city on their own behalf.
- Economists approached the city in terms of production relations in the city, architects in terms of physical structure and planning developments, geographers in terms of space-society interaction, political scientists in terms of management relations, and sociologists in terms of social structure and social relations.
- This situation has brought about an inevitable deficiency and diversity in city definitions.

(شهر)*i. (Persian. şehr)*
Among the settlements where people live collectively, it is the largest administratively and territorially located area after villages and towns; It is a crowded settlement center with no agricultural areas, most of whose people are engaged in trade, industry and administration.

Culture

- What makes a society different from other societies is its unique art, beliefs, customs, understanding and behavior, as well as its way of living and thinking, which has continued to change since the past and forms its identity.
- It is the whole of material and spiritual values that give society an identity, provide a sense of solidarity and unity, and ensure order in society.
- The whole of a nation's beliefs, ideas, art, customs and traditions, material and spiritual values.

Cultural Heritage

“Cultural heritage” is all of the concrete/material or intangible assets and facts that a society, community or mass currently preserves and created by previous generations (ancestors).

- Cultural heritage:
  - 1-**tangible** (material) such as buildings, monuments, books, works of art or crafts
  - 2-**intangible** such as folklore, tradition-custom, fairy-tale-myth.
  - 3-**nature assets** such as natural environment, biodiversity, geological ruins



- **The tangible (material) type of Cultural Heritage is called cultural assets (property).**
- Cultural assets; All movable and immovable assets above ground, underground or under water that are related to science, culture, religion and fine arts from prehistoric and historical periods or that have scientific and cultural unique value and were the subject of social life in prehistoric or historical periods.
- Cultural assets are divided into **movable** and **immovable**:

Movable Cultural Assets: glass, soil, metal, stone

Immovable Cultural Assets: monument, social complex, protected area

Sample of Movable cultural asset



Front side of a Gold coin



Back side of a Gold coin

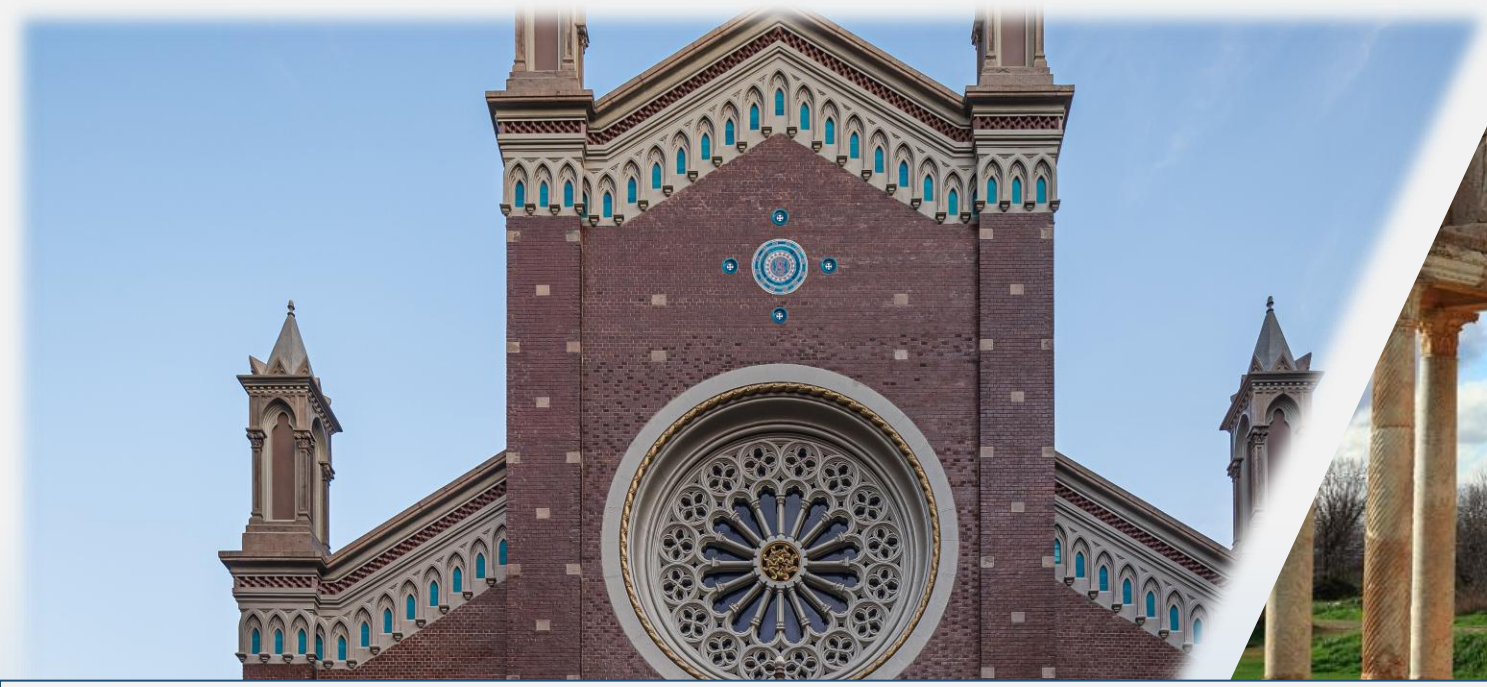
Notes: *Movable cultural assets unearthed during the* ***Yenikapı excavations*** *give clues about daily life since the Neolithic Age. Among the important findings were terracott a products from the Neolithic and Iron Ages; various pot types,including skyphos, oinokhoe, and aryballos, from the Classical period; coins, perfume bottles, and pots from theRoman and Byzanti ne periods; glasses and chalices, terracott a containers, oil lamps, lanterns, fl asks, bone and ivorygame pieces, wooden combs, boxes, spoons, bronze mirrors, keys, and leather sandal soles from the late Roman andByzanti ne eras and ti le and ceramic pieces from the Ott oman period. Some of these arti factsprovide clues about marine technology.*

Sample of Movable cultural asset



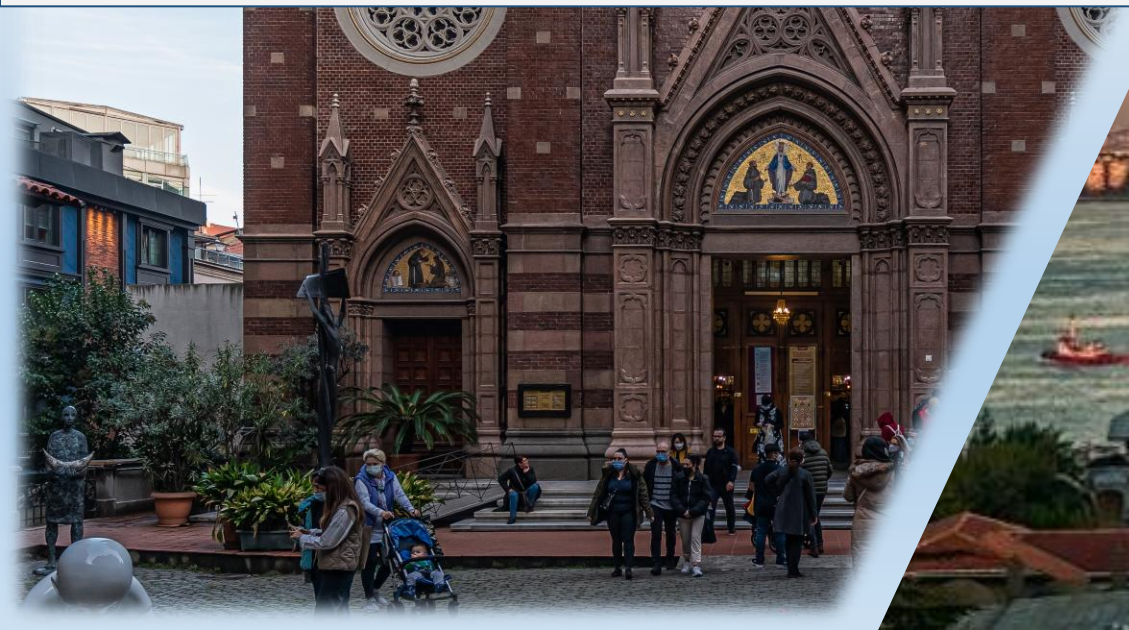
Uncovered from Yenikapı excavation

Parfume bottle





Samples of immovable cultural assets

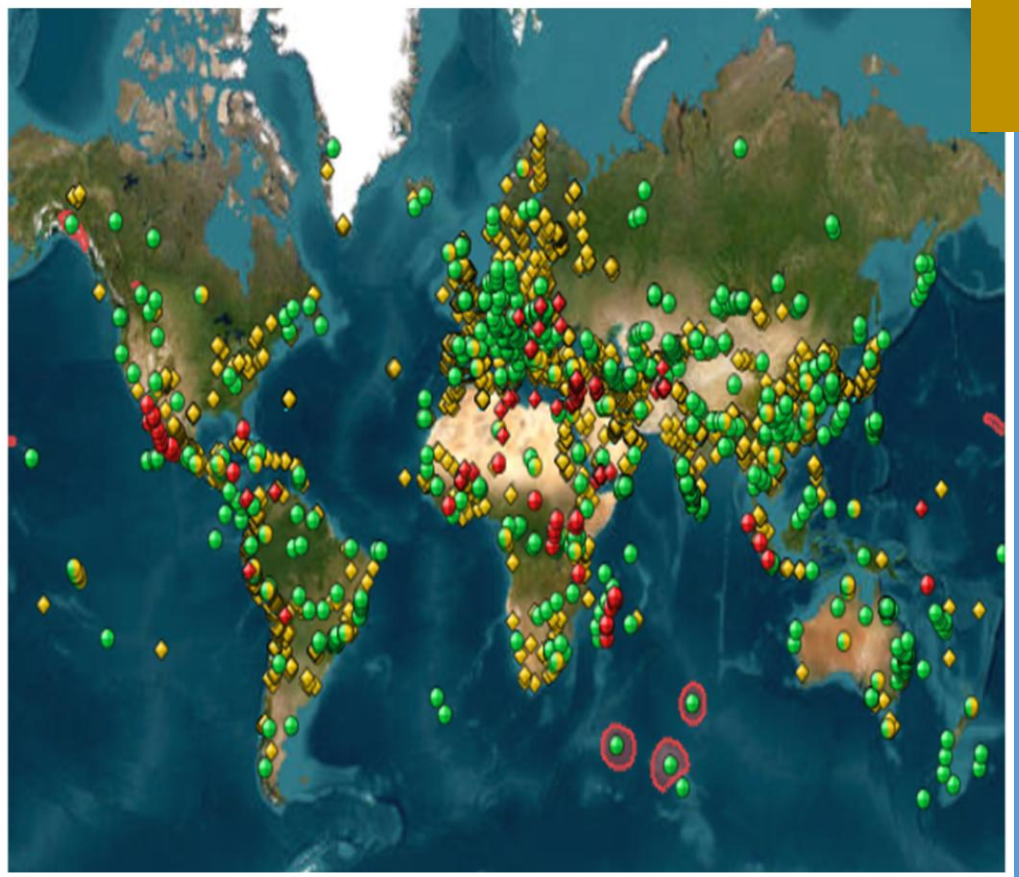




Immovable Cultural Assets

- **Cemeteries**: rock tombs, tumuli, necropolises, funerary monuments, mausoleums
- **Civil architecture**: mounds, ancient cities, ruins, acropolises, public buildings such as theatres, gymnasiums, caravanserais, inns, baths and madrassas, historical palaces, mansions, houses, waterside residences, fountains, almshouses, healing houses, dervish lodges and zawiyas, arastas, bazaars, covered bazaars
- **Religious Architecture**: temples, sanctuaries, basilicas, churches, mosques, masjids, musallas, prayer halls, altars, synagogues, monasteries
- **Military architecture**: castles, fortresses, bastions, walls, historical barracks, redoubts and fortifications and their fixed weapons,
- **Industrial architecture:** mills, olive oil and wine mills, shipyards, docks
- **Other**: written, illustrated and embossed rocks; illustrated caves, inscriptions, bridges, aqueducts, waterways, cisterns and wells, historical road ruins, perforated stones indicating old borders, obelisks, sarcophagi, stelae, frescoes, reliefs, mosaics

UNESCO World Heritage



"World Heritage" status is granted to natural formations, monuments and sites that are of international importance and therefore worth admiring and protecting.

UNESCO World Heritage



- In order to introduce the cultural and natural assets with universal values, which are accepted as the common heritage of all humanity, to the world, to create awareness in society to protect this universal heritage, and to ensure the necessary cooperation for the survival of cultural and natural values that are deteriorated or destroyed for various reasons, UNESCO's meeting between 17 October - 21 October Within the scope of the 17th General Conference held in Paris between November 1972, the "Convention Concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage" was adopted on 16 November 1972.

- After a series of procedures that begin with the application of the member states that have accepted the Convention to UNESCO and are completed as a result of the evaluation of the applications by the experts of the International Council on Monuments and Sites (ICOMOS) and the International Union for Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources (IUCN), candidate assets gain this status in accordance with the decision of the World Heritage Committee.

- As of 2023, there are 1199 cultural and natural assets registered on the UNESCO World Heritage List worldwide, 933 of which are cultural, 227 natural and 39 mixed (cultural/natural) assets. This number increases with the World Heritage Committee meetings held every year.

- As a result of the work carried out under the responsibility of the General Directorate of Cultural Heritage and Museums, 21 of assets from Türkiye have been included in the UNESCO World Heritage List so far.

- One of these assets is Historic Areas of Istanbul [1985] https://whc.unesco.org/en/list

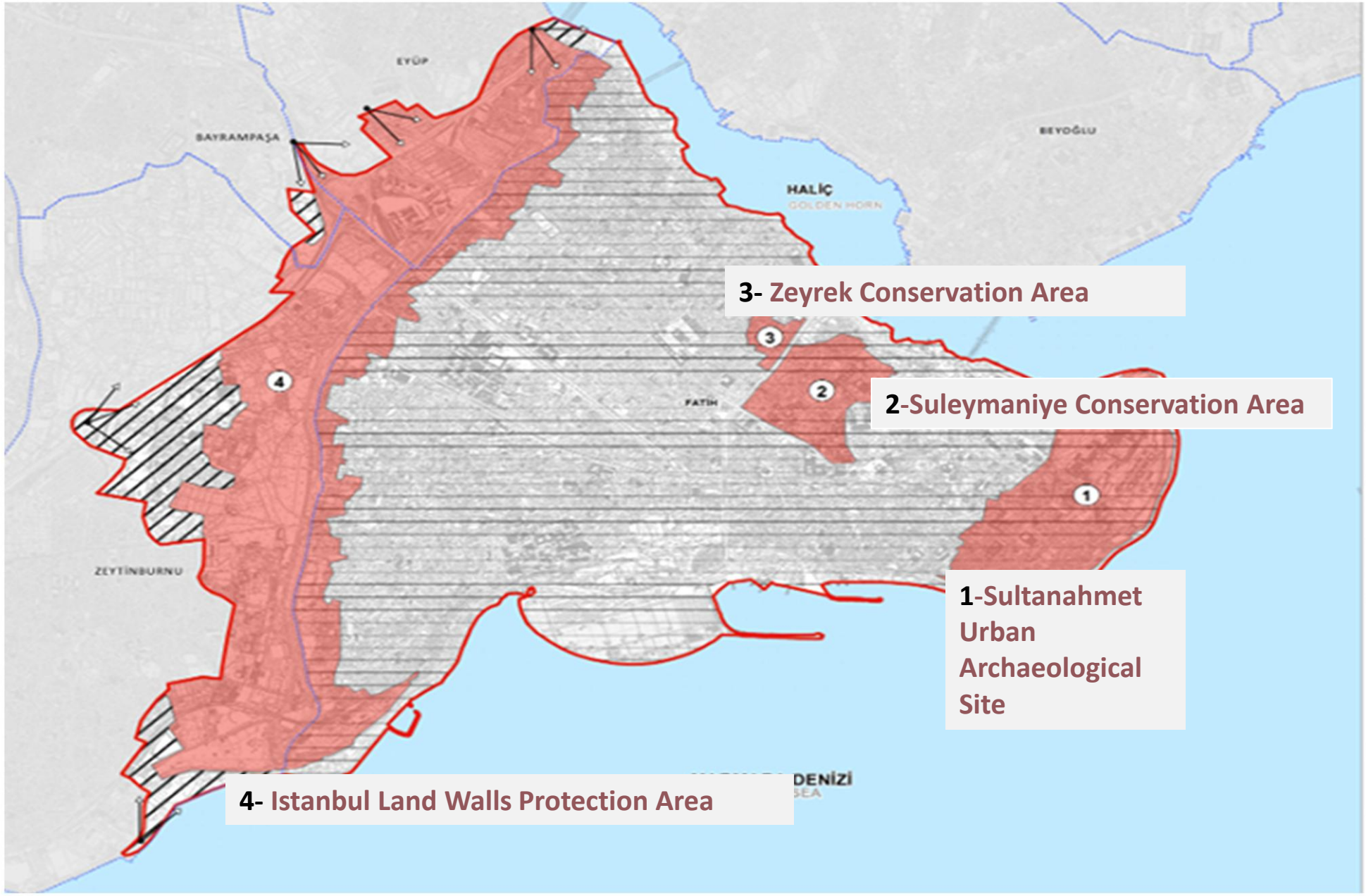
Historical Areas of Istanbul in UNESCO World Heritage

Istanbul was included in the UNESCO World Heritage List in 1985 as 4 regions:

- **Sultanahmet Urban Archaeological Site**, which includes the Hippodrome, Hagia Sophia, Hagia Irene, Little Hagia Sophia Mosque and Topkapi Palace
- **Suleymaniye Conservation Area**, which includes the Suleymaniye Mosque and its surroundings
- **Zeyrek Conservation Area**, which includes Zeyrek Mosque and its surroundings
- **Istanbul Land Walls Protection Area**

- https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/356
- https://istanbul.ktb.gov.tr/TR-276200/unesco-dunya-miras-listesi-ve-istanbul.html

ISTANBUL WORLD HERITAGE SITES



3- Zeyrek Conservation Area

2-Suleymaniye Conservation Area

1-Sultanahmet Urban Archaeological Site

4- Istanbul Land Walls Protection Area

SINIRLAR/BOUNDARIES

İlçe Sınırı
District Boundary

İstanbul Tarihi Yarımada Yönetim Planı Alanı
Istanbul Historic Peninsula Site Management Plan Area

Fatih İlçesi
Fatih District

Tampon Bölge
Buffer Zone

Bakı Noktaları
View Points

İstanbul'un Tarihi Alanları Dünya Mirası Alanı
Historic Areas of Istanbul World Heritage Site

1 Sultanahmet Kentsel Arkeolojik Koruma Alanı
Sultanahmet Urban Archaeological Component Area of World Heritage Site

2 Süleymaniye Camii ve Çevresi Koruma Alanı
Suleymaniye Mosque and its Associated Component Area of World Heritage Site

3 Zeyrek Camii ve Çevresi Koruma Alanı
Zeyrek Mosque(Pantocrator Church) and its Associated Component Area of World Heritage Site

4 İstanbul Kara Surları Koruma Alanı
Istanbul Land Walls Component Area of World Heritage Site

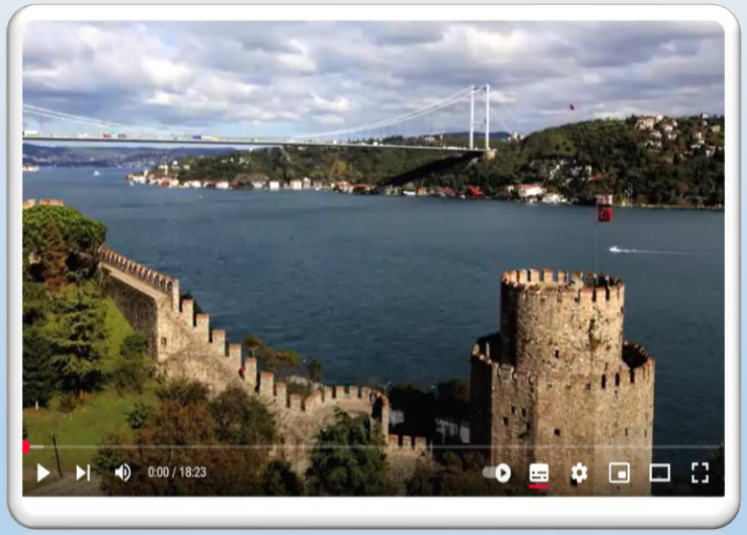
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İSTANBUL BÜYÜKŞEHİR BELEDİYESİ

ISTANBUL'S WORLD HERITAGE SITES

http://www.alanbaskanligi.gov.tr/

İstanbul Alan Başkanlığı





https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lVRadiDJBX0



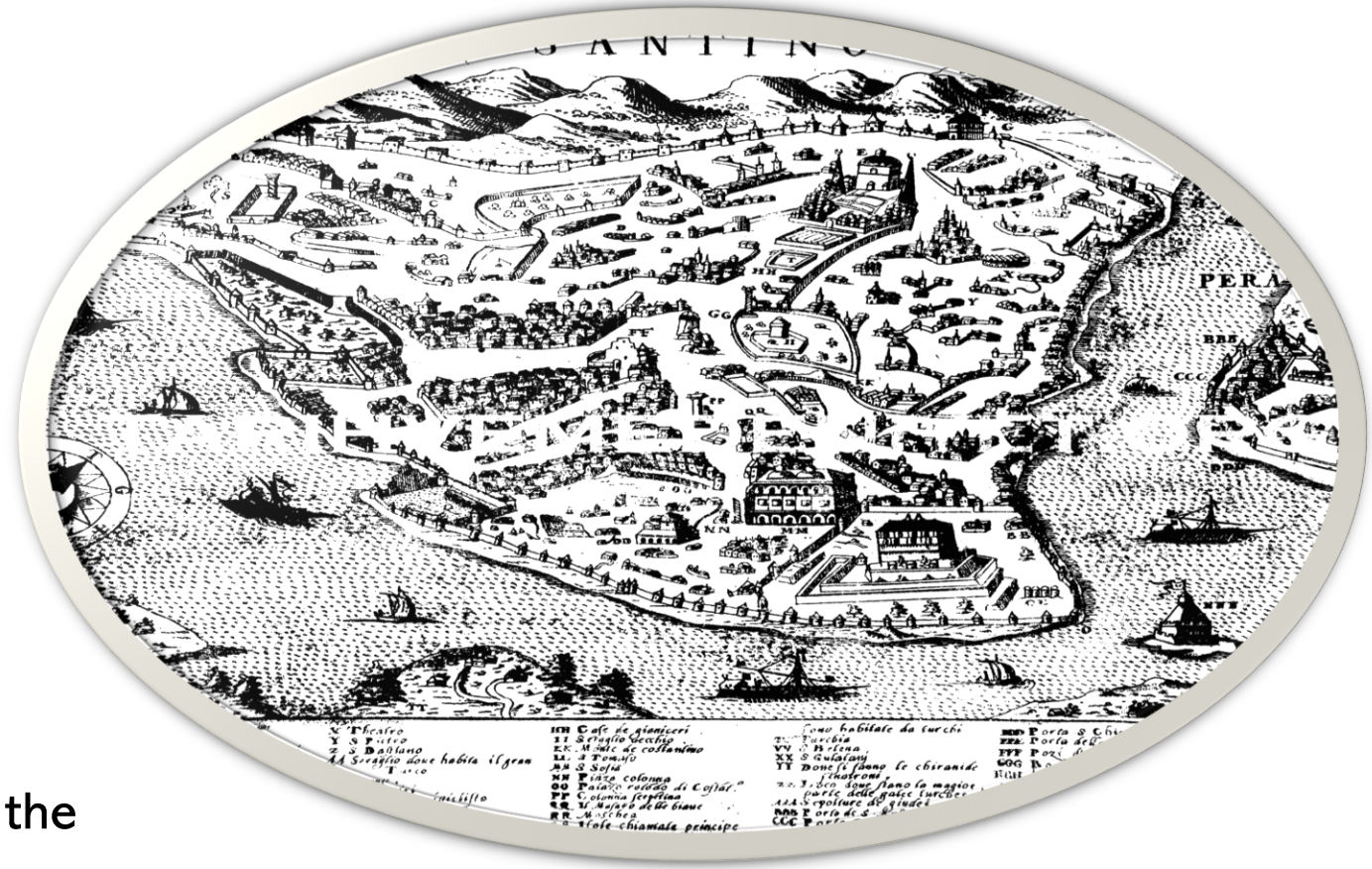
Engraving (*gravür*) by Christoforo Buondelmonte, dated 1422

The Names

- Istanbul, which is called the "queen of cities" in the sources, has been known by different names such as Byzantion, Antonina and Constantinople throughout history.



İstanbul (Stanpolis)



- Stanpolis is of Ancient Greek origin.
- The meaning of the word comes from the phrase "eis ten polin" meaning "to go towards the city" and "inside the city".
- It is thought that this name was first used with the beginning of urbanization in the region.



Likos (Lygos)

- It is known as one of the oldest recorded name of Istanbul.
- With different pronunciations, the word is also known as Likos, Lycvs, Lygos, Licus and Lükos..
- Bayrampaşa Stream was formerly called Likos Stream. It was one of the first settlements in the region.
- Lykos (Bayrampaşa) stream: The historical stream passing through where today's Vatan Street is and flowing into the sea from Yenikapı.

- Painting Showing the Lykos Stream Made by Painter William Purser in the 18th Century



Byzantion

The name given to the ancient city founded by settlers from the city of Megara in Ancient Greece, meaning "Byzas' city", after a commander or king named **Byzas**.

This name was influential in 18th and 19th century researchers defining Eastern Rome as the "Byzantine Empire"..

Augusta Antonina

Roman Emperor Septimius Severus gave this name to honor his son Antonius after rebuilding the city.



Nova Roma

- After it became the capital of the Roman Empire, it was named Nova Roma (New Rome).

Constantinople (Costantinapol)

- This name was used after the death of Constantine the Great (Constantine I), the founder of Byzantium, also known as the Eastern Roman Empire. In official records, it was determined that the name was first approved and used by Theodosius, one of the emperors..
- Western states continued to use Constantinople until the early 20th century. It was also commemorated in this way after Fatih Sultan Mehmet conquered the city..

Konstantiniyye

- Konstantiniyye is the Arabic form of Constantinople. It is one of the most frequently used names both in historical sources and by the public after the Ottoman Conquest..

Names used by the Ottoman world after the conquest of the city by the Ottomans

*Dersaadet (Gate of Happiness)

*Makarri Saltanat (Sultanate center)

*Asitane-i Aliyye

(Âsitane-i saâdet, Âsitâne-i sultanate, Âsitâne-i aliyye)

*Darülhilafe (Gate of the Caliphate)





- Until the Yenikapı excavations, our information about the prehistoric periods of Istanbul came from areas **outside** the historical peninsula.
- It was not known that there was a settlement **inside** the historical peninsula in ancient times.

- The place where the excavation was carried out is an old port: **Theodosius Harbour**

- The archaeological remains, graves and other remains which were revealed during the archaeological excavations in Yenikapı central station and other subway stations have been the first data that proved the existence of the **Neolithic Period** in the Historical Peninsula. Moreover, the remains of the first humans in Istanbul were detected in Yenikapı as well.

- The settlement of the Neolithic Period in Yenikapı, which is more likely sort of a fishing village, has a special importance in terms of documenting the historical background of Istanbul back to 6500 BC

  - The existence of important Neolithic settlements outside the Historical Peninsula have already been known so far.
  - Depending on the settlements which were revealed after the archaeological excavations of Yarımburgaz Cave in European Side and of Fikirtepe and Pendik-Temenye and the ones which were revealed during a foundation excavation in Tuzla-Kale Kapısı in Asian Side it was interpreted that all the mentioned settlements were similar to the ones in Yenikapı and had the features of simple villages. It was determined that the pottery in Istanbul were produced and used in the settlements of the Neolithic Period.

- The remains that were revealed in Yenikapı excavations indicate the clues dealing with what happened in the Historical Peninsula as well as in Istanbul.
- It is understood that the Neolithic village, which is located where Lykos (Bayrampaşa Stream) meets the sea, was 6.5 m under the sea level.
- The archaeological excavations that were carried out on a wide range have proven that the settlement which was founded in 6500 BC was destroyed by the sea in around 5300/5200 BC.
- This proved that the Sea of Marmara was a sweet-water lake before the 6th century BC and the Neolithic Village in Yenikapı was founded on one of the last elevations between Lake Marmara and the Bosporus.

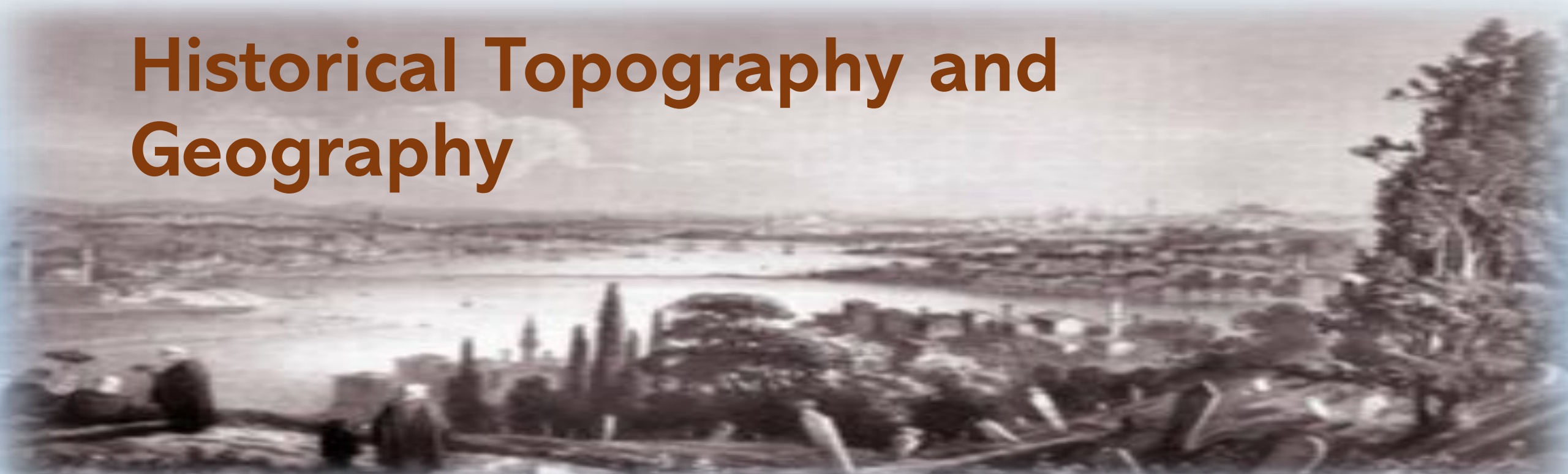




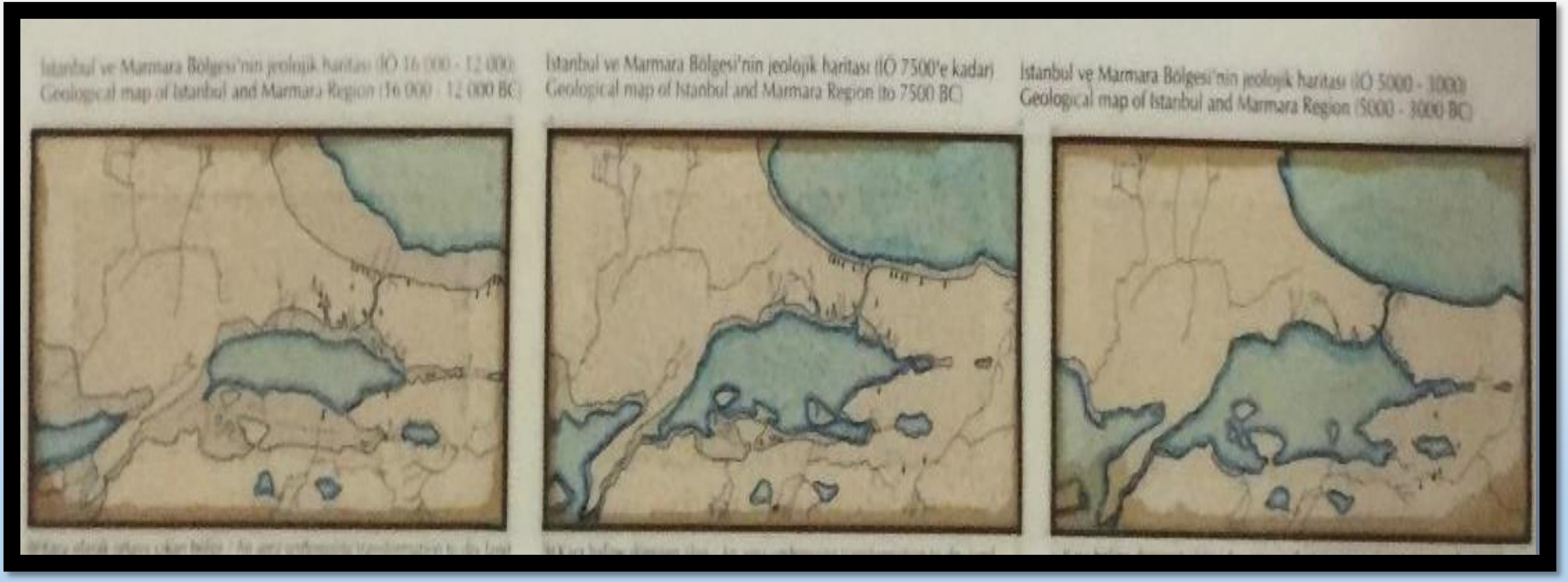
boat remains

Yenikapı excavations:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PA8J6pp7hPg

Historical Topography and Geography



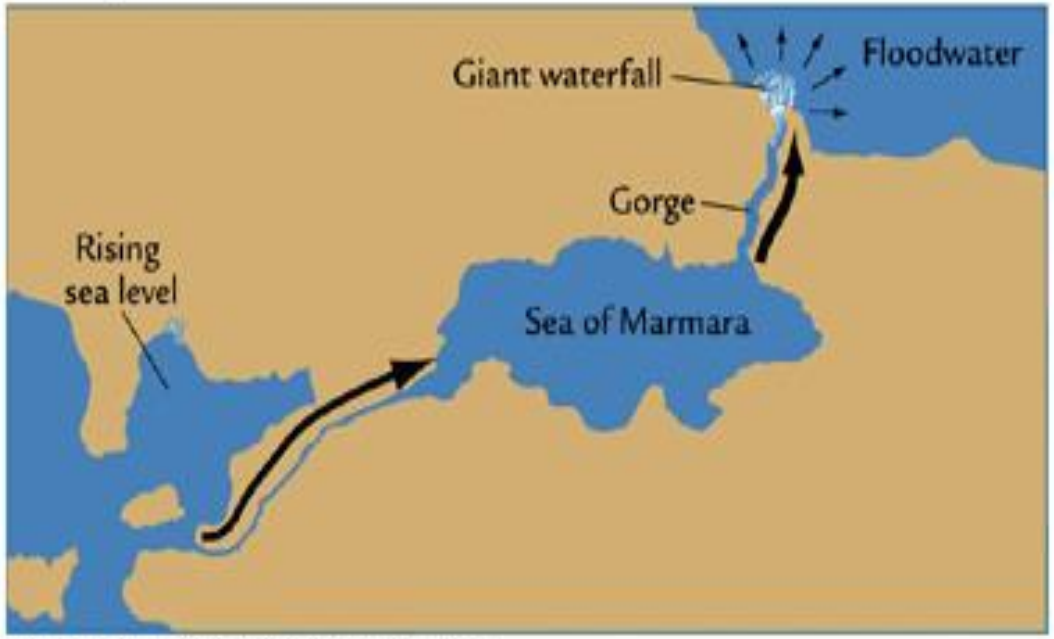
- **During prehistoric times, the sea level in the Marmara region changed significantly. As a result, the coastline also changed, and some prehistoric sites are now submerged beneath the waters of the Marmara Sea.**



Geological map of Istanbul and Marmara Region from 7500 to 3000 BC.



A Last glaciation



B Deglacial flood (7600 years ago)

It is possible to gather the many views put forward regarding the formation of the Bosphorus in four groups:

- **The emergence of the Bosphorus as a result of the overflow of the Black Sea, through erosion.**
- **The formation of the Bosphorus as a result of a volcanic eruption.**
- **The emergence of the Bosphorus as a result of tectonic movements, through collapse and without an explosion, through fracture.**
- **The widening of the channel as a result of the Black Sea, which was at a lower level than today as a result of the III. Period, invading the river beds towards the middle of the IV. Period.**

Several theories have been proposed about the formation and development of the Bosphorus. Changes in sea level are considered an important part of this process.

- In the Ice Ages, the Sea of Marmara and the Black Sea were lakes, and the Straits of Istanbul and the Dardanelles were valleys.
- The physical geography of Istanbul was shaped by the effects of natural movements that occurred over time.
- Moreover, the geographical features of Istanbul, the cultural approaches and the ways they used physical space have shaped and greatly transformed the topography of the city of Istanbul throughout history.
- From the foundation of the city to the present day, the dwellings, monumental structures, green areas and transportation features of the city have been enriched in a way that reflects the characteristics of each period of civilization it has hosted, and have formed the topography of today's Istanbul.
- The topography of Istanbul has developed while maintaining its continuity and has reached today.
- Today's Istanbul topography has taken its current form with the contributions of different civilizations.

The Bosphorus

- The Bosphorus is in the form of a “water channel”. The Bosphorus separates Europe and Asia.
- It is the only waterway that unites the Black Sea and Mediterranean cultures.
- It is an exceptional place where two continents and seas meet and the only gate of the Black Sea basin. These features make Istanbul one of the most important intersections in the world.
- It is the part between the Tophane-Salacak line in the south and the Rumelia and Anatolian lighthouses line in the north.







- The Bosphorus water channel is 31 km long on the north-south axis.
- Its width is 3,600 meters where it opens to the Black Sea and 1,675 meters in Marmara.
- The narrowest point of the Bosphorus is between Rumeli and Anadolu Hisarı (Rumeli and Anatolian Fortresses) at 698 meters.
- Its shores are parallel to each other as if torn in the middle. There is a gulf or bay opposite each cape and mouth.
- The land on both sides is divided by valleys.





The Rumeli Fortress





The Anadolu Fortress

The narrowest point of the Bosphorus

The map of Bosphorus Shores, 1878



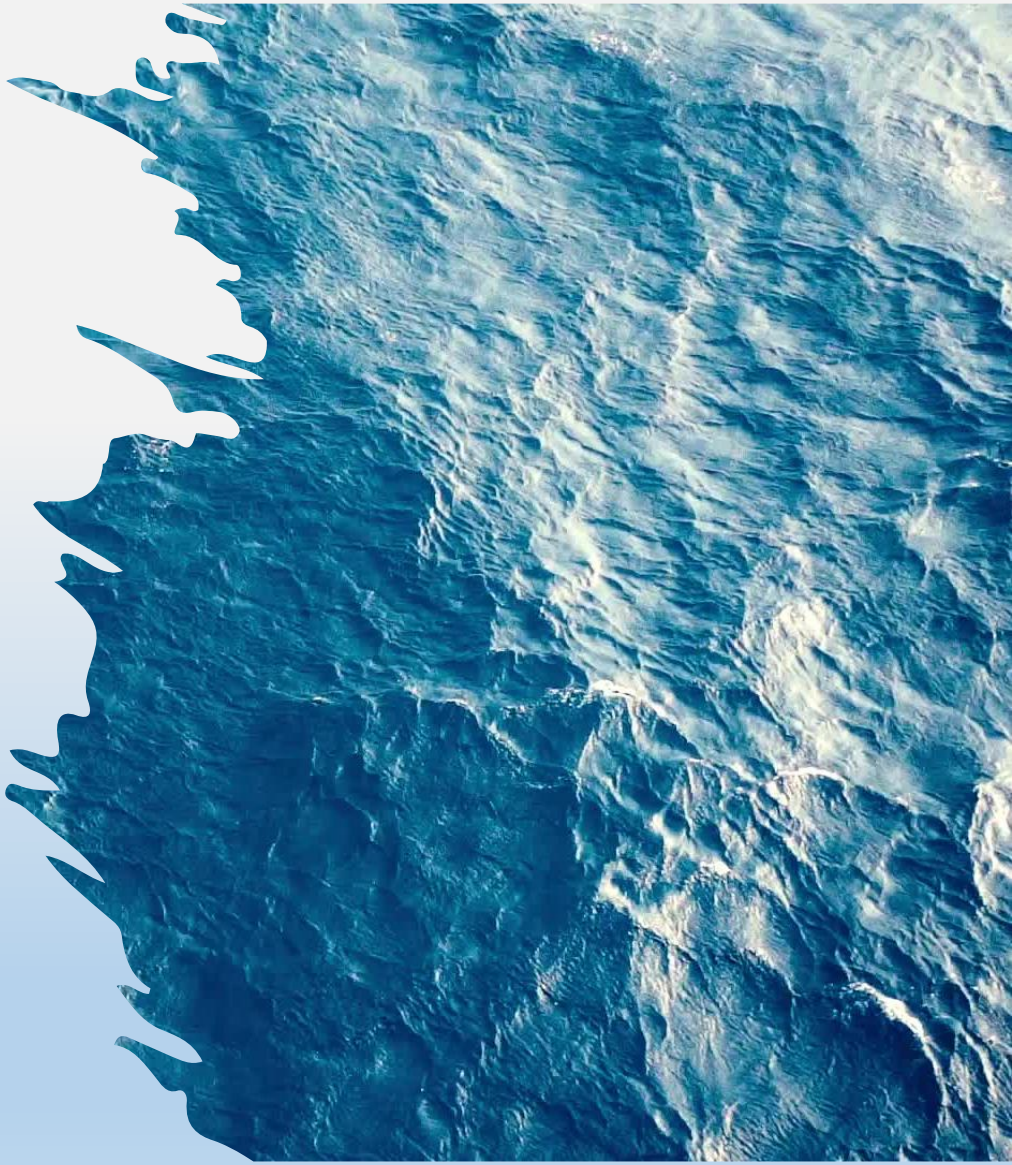
- Istanbul was known to ancient historians as the “Queen of the Bosphorus” or the “Pearl of the Bosphorus”; there is ample evidence that these titles were well-deserved.
- However, **the city’s most important asset was its location, on which its other advantageous features depended.**
- Byzantium was located on the Thracian (European) shore of the Bosphorus – which divides the Black Sea (Pontos Euxeinos) from the Sea of Marmara (Propontis) – and more specifically at its southern extremity, as it opens onto the Sea of Marmara.
- This location was also known to ancient authors as the narrowest part of the Bosphorus.
- Previously, passage through the Bosphorus – i.e., on the Mediterranean-Aegean-Black Sea route – had been the most important issue.
- As passage from one side of the Bosphorus to the other – i.e., between Thrace and Anatolia – became more frequent, Byzantium’s strategic location, from which it controlled Bosphorus traffic, became more crucial.
- According to Polybius, Byzantium’s maritime location was more secure and profitable than that of all known cities in the world. When it came to its location on land, however, the opposite was the case.
- The current of the Bosphorus made the setting of Byzantium even more suitable and advantageous. According to Polybius, the Bosphorus current made it easier for ships to reach Byzantium; its setting also served as a natural harbor for ships.

Bosphorus Currents

- There are two main currents in the Bosphorus: the first is the surface current, and the second is the bottom current, which starts about 15 meters below the surface and can be effective up to 45 meters deep, as the depth allows.
- While the surface current flows generally from the Black Sea to the Marmara, the bottom current is the opposite, from the Marmara to the Black Sea.
- The Black Sea has a water level 40 centimeters higher than the Marmara. The main reason for the surface current from the Black Sea to the Marmara is this difference in altitude.
- The waters of the Black Sea, which is at a higher level, “flow” towards the Marmara, which is at a lower level.



- The speed of this surface current, which runs from north to south, reaches its highest level during the periods when the northern winds that fill the Black Sea waters towards the mouth of the strait are effective. The waters of the strait flow like a river during these periods.
- On the other hand, the salinity rate of the Black Sea is low due to its constant feeding with fresh water and the fact that salty water is partially carried by surface currents. The Sea of Marmara is approximately twice as salty as the Black Sea.
- This bottom current, which is formed by the difference in salinity between the two seas, has neither a speed nor a flow rate as great as the surface current. The amount of water carried to the south by the surface current is approximately two and a half times greater than the amount of water carried to the north by the bottom current.

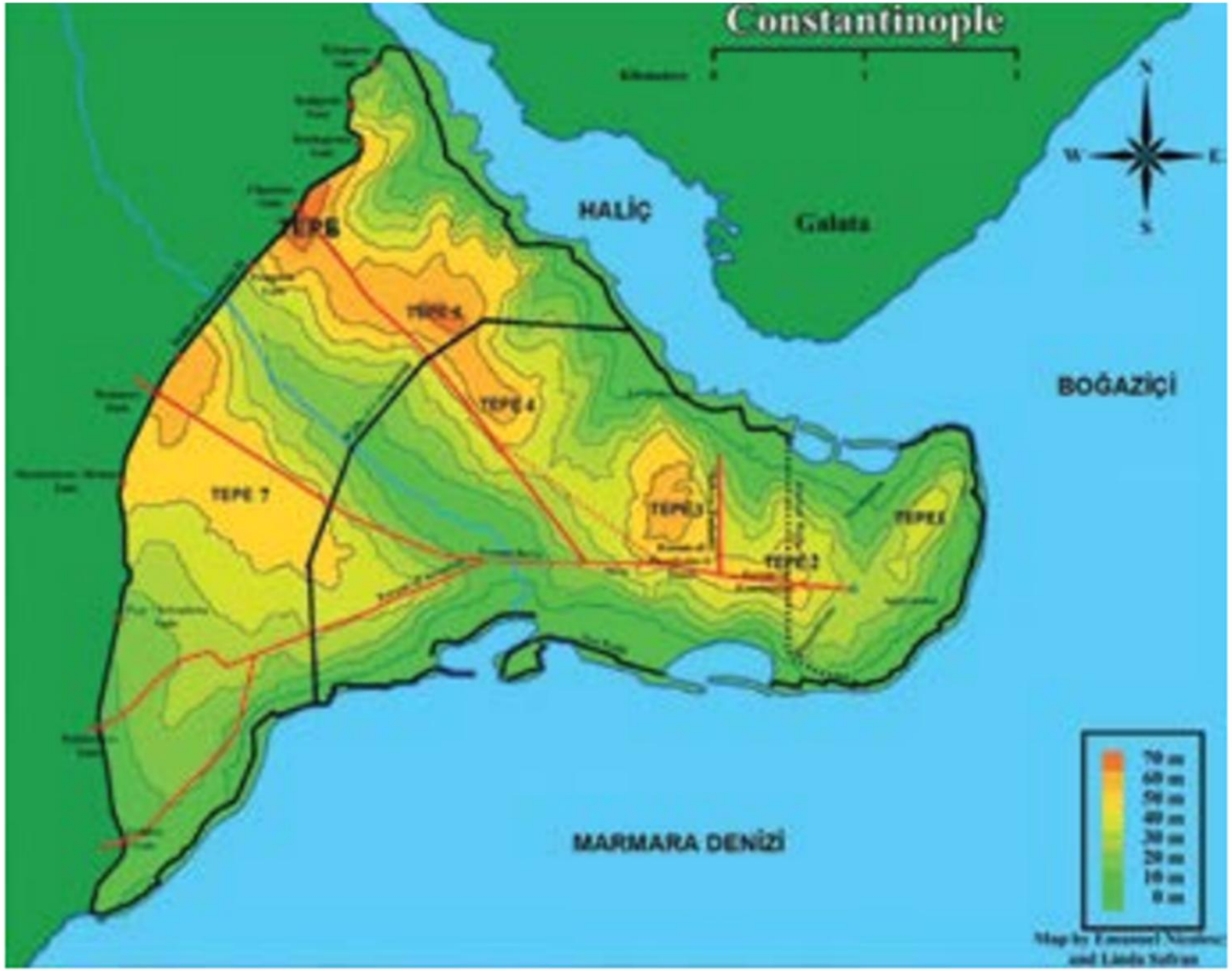




- The dominant current regime in the Bosphorus is the surface current and is largely parallel to the dominant wind regime. In fact, the North Winds (Poyraz) are the dominant winds of the region and when these winds are strong, the current is also at its strongest.
- Although rare, South winds (Lodos) and especially Lodos are effective from time to time and there are strong Lodos winds in Istanbul that can cause even city line ships to cancel their voyages.
- These winds pile up the waters of Marmara towards the north and can raise the water level by half a meter at the southern entrance of the Bosphorus. In this case, the current regime of the Bosphorus also changes; a reverse current called "orkoz/undertow" occurs on the surface. This current sometimes reaches the speed of the North Current. This North Current is more dangerous for ships than the South Current.



Sekil 4. İstanbul'da Hakim Rüzgâr Yönü



Sekil 5. Tarihi Yarımada'nın topoğrafyası

Winds and Topography

Haliç/The Golden Horn *(Altın Boynuz)*

- The Golden Horn is the name which was given in antiquity to the estuary (Tr. nehir ağzı/haliç) known in Turkish as the Haliç, which separates the plateaus on which the old city of Istanbul and present-day Beyoğlu are located. Bonito constituted the city's most important natural resource, and the Golden Horn (Chrysokeras) was where they were mostly frequently found and caught.
- Many ancient authors referred to this estuary as a "horn"; Strabo likens it to the horn of a deer. The Latin author Pliny refers to it as the "Golden Horn"; explaining why he chooses to give it this name, he writes:
  - *At the narrowest point in the Thracian Strait (the Bosphorus) which connects the Sea of Marmara to the Black Sea and separates Europe and Asia, in the vicinity of Chalcedon on the Asian side, there is a magnificent white rock which shimmers through the water, from the depths up to the surface. Whenever the bonito see this rock lying before them, they always become frightened, one aft er another. They make their way in a school directly towards the cape of Byzantium, on the other side. This is why this place is known as the "Golden Horn." In the end, they are all caught by fishermen in Byzantium.*
- According to Pliny, the place called "Keras" (Horn) is known as the "Golden Horn" due to the fact that this stream is teeming with fish. Likewise, Strabo states that the current forced bonito to enter this estuary in a school,and that in a narrow part of the stream, they could even be caught by hand. Thus, in Byzantium, the fruit-filled "hornof plenty" (cornucopia) of antiquity was transformed into one filled with bonito; the term "golden" referred to the bonito themselves.



Bonito means "palamut" in Turkish. Fishing was an important economic activity in ancient Byzantium.

Haliç/The Golden Horn

- Since it is an arc-shaped indentation starting from Sarayburnu-Galata and extending first to the west and then curving northwest, Westerners have found the meaning of “golden horn” for the Golden Horn.
- It was formed when a river mouth formed by the confluence of Alibeyköy and Kağıthane streams was flooded at the end of the period called the Ice Age.
- While it is 200 m. in the upper parts at the level of Eyüp, this width increases downwards and reaches 700 meters between Cibali-Kasımpaşa. Similarly, its depth increases as it approaches the Bosphorus from the upper parts.

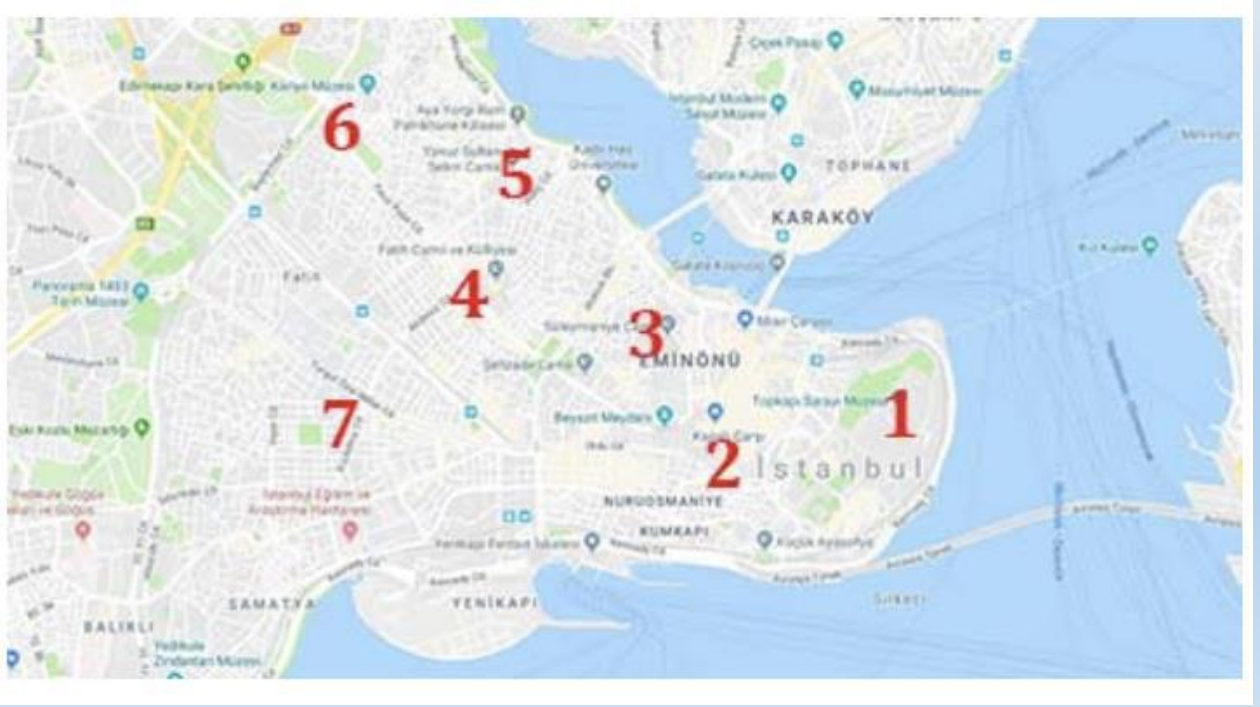
***A large natural harbor



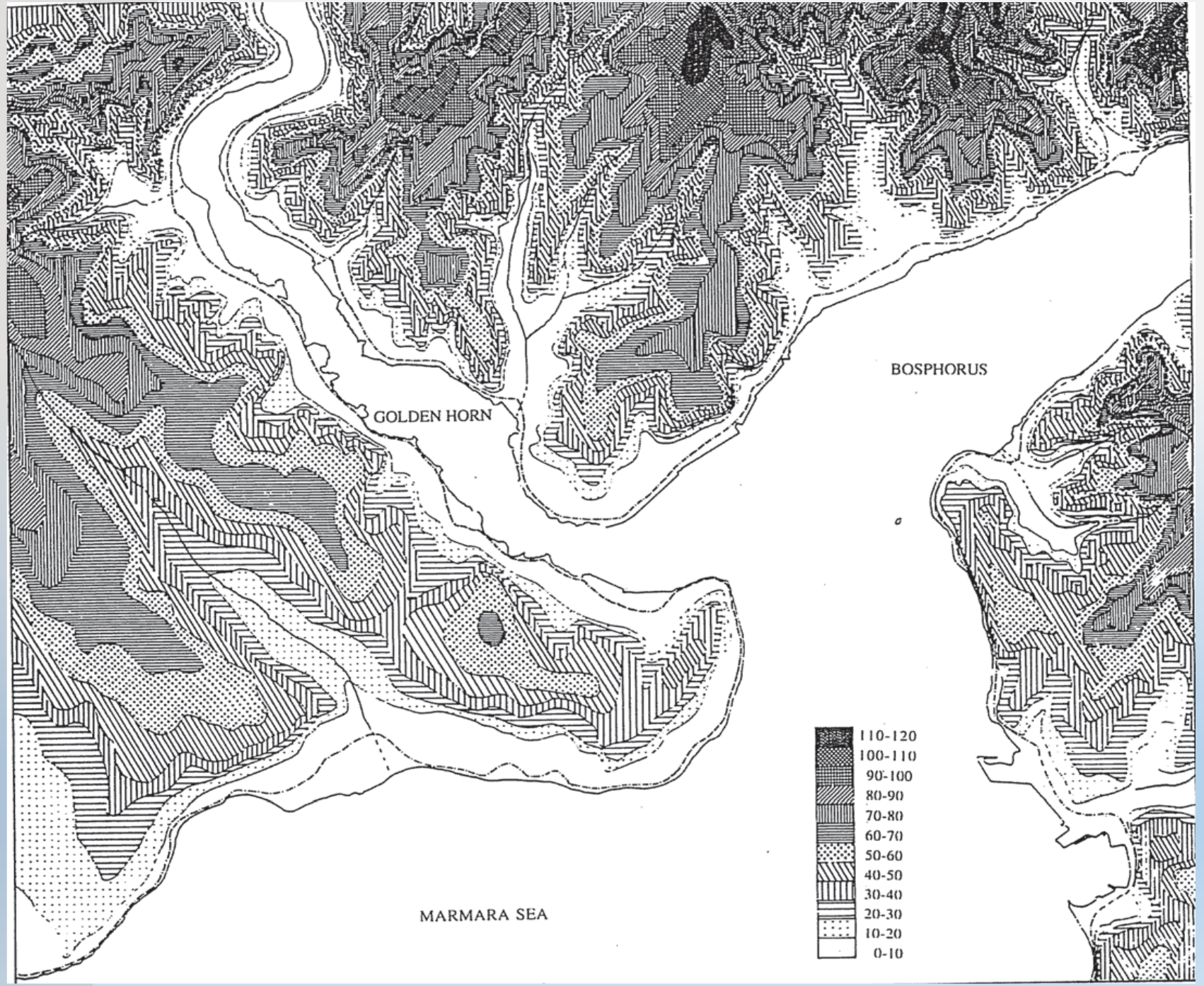
- Istanbul is a city established in an **earthquake** zone.
- Earthquakes and tectonic movements over time have created **islands/islets** around the city.
- On the other hand, **hills** with increasing elevation have emerged within the city. İstanbul is also known as «*the city of seven hills*».

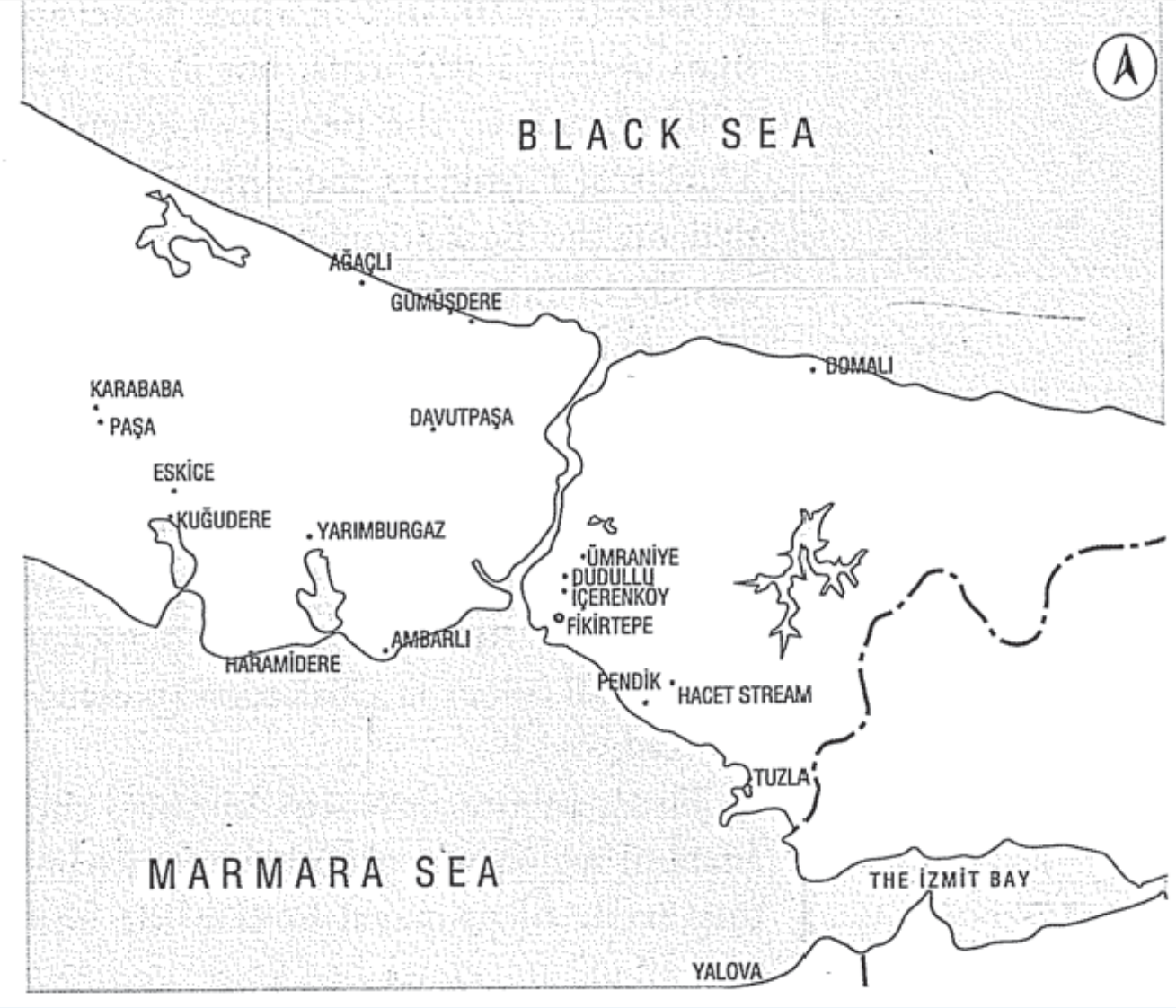
The Roman, Byzantine and Ottoman Empires built Istanbul on seven hills, all of which are located within the borders of "Suriçi Istanbul" in the Historical Peninsula.

- *1. Sarayburnu Hill*
- *2. Çemberlitaş Hill*
- *3. Süleymaniye (Beyazıt) Hill*
- *4. Fatih Hill*
- *5. Yavuz Selim Hill*
- *6. Edirnekapı Hill*
- *7. Kocamustafapaşa Hill*



- **Geographical features, the civilizations that have lived in Istanbul throughout history, and the way these civilizations used physical space have shaped the topography of Istanbul.**

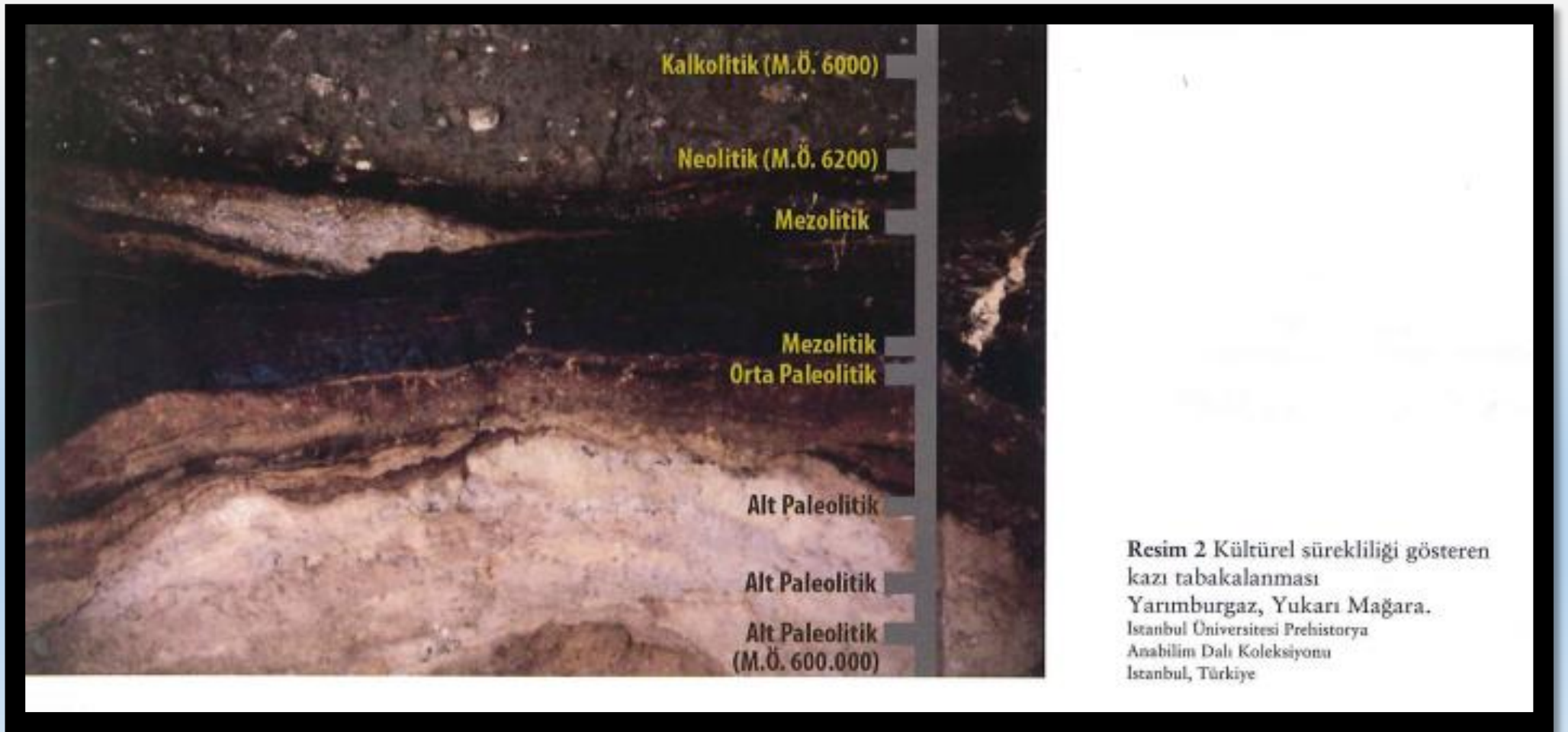




Prehistoric Settlements in Istanbul and Its Surroundings

PALEOLITHIC AGE (1 million-10,000 years ago)

- YARIMBURGAZ CAVE near Küçük Çekmece Lake
- Tools used by people who make a living from fishing and hunting



Resim 2 Kültürel sürekliliği gösteren kazı tabakalanması
Yarımburgaz, Yukarı Mağara.
İstanbul Üniversitesi Prehistorya Anabilim Dalı Koleksiyonu
İstanbul, Türkiye

NEOLITHIC AGE (6,600-5,800 BC)

- Marmara was a narrower lake during this period. The first Neolithic settlements near the shore were established near the streams flowing into this lake and over time they were submerged under the Sea of Marmara.

- Yenikapı, FİKİRTEPE, İçerenköy, Pendik-Kaynarca, Tuzla-İçmeler

- The Neolithic Age communities of Istanbul are called the «**Fikirtepe Culture**».
- Partly agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting, fishing
- Pottery, tools



Resim 4 Neolitik döneme ait Fikirtepe kültüründe kemik-kaşık olarak adlandırılan aletler
Fikirtepe-Pendik

CHALCOLITHIC AGE (5,800-3,200 BC)

- Cultures of Yenikapı and Yarımburgaz Cave dating to this period.
- Our information about this period is limited.



BRONZE AGE (3200-1100 BC)

- Limited information
- Ayamama Creek in Ataköy, Moda Bay

EARLY IRON AGE (1100-900 BC)

- Ataköy Ayamama Creek, Yenikapı
- During this period, a wave of migration from the Northern Balkans spread from Istanbul to Thrace.



Figure 11 a-d: İnsan Yüzü Betimli Çömlek, Hipodrom, Geç Kalkolitik Çağ, Pişmiş Toprak / *Jug with the Human Face Decoration, Hippodrome, Late Chalcolithic Period, Terracotta*



Figure 19 ab: Testi, Fenerbahçe Yat Limanı, Erken Tunç Çağı II-III, Pişmiş Toprak / *Pitcher, Fenerbahçe Yacht Harbour, Early Bronze Age II-III, Terracotta*

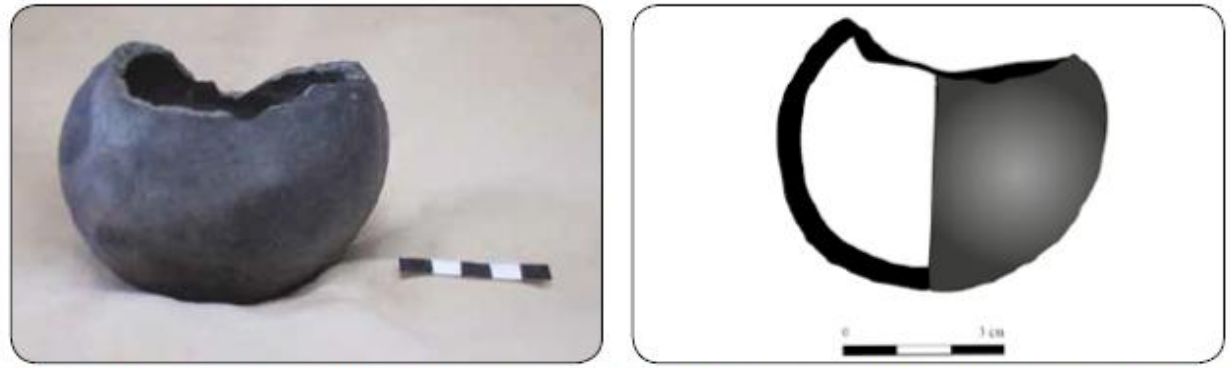


Figure 20 ab: Testi, Fenerbahçe Yat Limanı, Erken Tunç Çağı II-III, Pişmiş Toprak / *Pitcher, Fenerbahçe Yacht Harbour, Early Bronze Age II-III, Terracotta*

The Legend of the City's Foundation

- The widespread legend about the city's first foundation is that it was founded as a Megarian colony (659 BC).
- According to the legend, the name of the commander at the head of the Megarians was Byzas, and the name of the city came from there.

- The founding of Byzantium by Byzas is recounted as a legend, which exists in a few different versions. Ancient sources and legends supply the following information concerning the identity of Byzas:

(a) he was a Thracian king who was the son of a local nymph(water fairy) named Semestra;
(b) he was the son of Poseidon and Keroessa, the daughter of Io;
(c) he was the leader of the Megarians.

The Legend..

According to the second legend, Io, the daughter of the Argive king Inachus, was the priestess of the Temple of Hera in the city of Argos. One day, the god Zeus saw Io and fell in love with her. On learning that her husband Zeus was enamored of another woman, Hera became consumed with jealousy, and sought ways to separate Io from Zeus. In order to protect Io from Hera's wrath, Zeus turned her into a cow. However, Hera asked that the cow be given to her; she took Io, and set the thousand-eyed giant Argos to guard her. Zeus then sent Hermes, the messenger god, who put Argos into a trance, and then killed him. Io was freed from the giant; however, this time Hera sent a horsefly to harass her. Whenever the fly bit her, Io – in the guise of a cow – felt great discomfort; she came from Thrace to the Bosphorus, and crossed to the Asian side, arriving at what is now the neighborhood of Eyüp at the end of the Golden Horn. Aft er crossing the Golden Horn (Chrysokeras), Iogave birth to a daughter, whom she named Keroessa. Keroessa had a child, Byzas, with the sea-god Poseidon. Byzas was brought up by a nymph named Byzia; when he became a young man, he went on to found the city of Byzantium.

Because of the story of Io crossing the Bosphorus in the form of a cow, the Bosphorus acquired its name (Bosporos literally means "Cow Crossing"). This anecdote was well-known in antiquity. Though it would appear, according to this legend, that the place where Byzas and the colonists decided to found the city of Byzanti um was at the site of present-day Sivritepe on the shore of the Golden Horn (the location of the Altar of Semystra), the legend nonetheless indicates Sarayburnu (now occupied by Topkapı Palace) as the place where the city was founded. Dionysius of Halicarnassus has recounted, upon deciding to found the city, the colonists sacrificed an animal; as they were cooking it, a crow snatched a piece of its meat from the flames and flew away with it into the sky. However, guided by a shepherd – who watched where the crow went from a high hill – they discovered that the crow had taken the piece of sacrificial meat to the Bosphorus Cape. The colonists regarded this as a divine portent, and founded the city on the cape (today's Sarayburnu). On the obverse of Byzantium's coins minted under the Roman Empire, there is a helmeted, bearded bust of Byzas, along with an inscription indicating his name in Greek (ΒΥΖΑΣ).

The historical ages begin in Istanbul with the Greek colonies.

Next Week: Byzantine Periods